

a simpler, more intuitive and free alternative comes in the form of web apps. Luckily, there's no shortage of these, but we've picked out a few for you to start off with:

- a. **Picasa Web Albums / Google+ :** If you already have a Google account, then storing your photos on Picasa Web Albums (<http://dgit.in/MrqYcy>) should be a no-brainer. You can create dedicated photo albums in Picasa, (or you can choose to store them in a folder in Google Drive), tag people or places in the album, share it with others either via email or Google+. Both Google+ and Picasa now allow some basic photo editing functions, courtesy Google's acquisition of Picnik. You can crop, resize, sharpen and rotate images, fix colour or exposure problems, apply filters, captions or even some funky effects like moustaches or crowns!
- b. **Aviary:** While Aviary is an internet suite of applications for image, web and audio files, their best-known product is the Image Editor called Phoenix (<http://dgit.in/NDnbOv>). It allows for several common fixes to your images, with features including different sized brushes, a magic wand, a fill tool and many other tools that have become standard with image editors. The web-app requires Java to run, but apps are also available for Android and iOS devices.



Pixlr provides a familiar looking interface for an image editor

- c. **Pixlr - Pixlr** (<http://dgit.in/MtxRxx>) provides probably the most familiar looking interface for those who're used to working with Adobe Photoshop or GIMP. You get a palette of tools on the left, your image in the center and smaller windows for layers, navigation and history on the right.

5. Chat / IRC clients:

Instead of having a dedicated client for every chat protocol like Google Talk, Facebook Chat or MSN Messenger, these web apps allow you to club together your various online accounts under one app and manage your conversations in a neat way. Meebo, a very popular IM client was discontinued after its acquisition by Google earlier this year, so we chose not to include it in this list.

- a. eBuddy (www.ebuddy.com)
- b. Imo.im (www.imo.im)